

PROJECT PROPOSAL PROFORMA (ANNEXURE A)

INDIRA GANDHI NATIONAL OPEN UNIVERSITY

B.A. TOURISM STUDIES (BTS)

Candidate Information (to be filled by the candidate)

Date: _____

Name: _____

Programme Code: BTS Course Code: PTS-1

Enrolment No.: _____

Address: _____

Regional Centre: _____

Study Centre Name and Code: _____

Title of the Project

Role of Salugara Monastery in Promoting Buddhist Cultural Tourism in Siliguri Region

Synopsis / Proposal (about 400 words)

Background and Rationale: Salugara Monastery in the Siliguri region is a living Buddhist institution with strong spiritual value and visible tourism relevance. The site attracts pilgrims, culture-oriented visitors, and transit tourists moving towards Darjeeling, Kalimpong, and Sikkim corridors. Despite this importance, there is limited structured local documentation on how the monastery contributes to Buddhist cultural tourism, visitor learning, and local livelihood support. The proposed project addresses this gap through field-based case study research.

Aim and Objectives: The aim is to evaluate the role of Salugara Monastery in promoting Buddhist cultural tourism in the Siliguri region and to propose practical recommendations for responsible growth. The key objectives are: (1) to profile visitor motivation, behaviour, and flow patterns; (2) to document cultural and ritual heritage interpretation at the site; (3) to assess local economic linkages around transport, food, retail, and short-stay demand; (4) to identify constraints related to signage, interpretation, amenities, and management coordination; and (5) to suggest a sustainable and culturally respectful development model.

Methodology and Data: The study will use a mixed-method design with primary and secondary data. Primary data will be collected through visitor questionnaires, semi-structured interviews with monastic representatives and local stakeholders, and direct field observation. Secondary material will include tourism policy documents, IGNOU study resources, and published tourism statistics. Data will be classified into themes such as cultural value, visitor experience, local benefits, and sustainability risks. Basic percentage analysis and thematic interpretation will be used.

Scope, Work Plan, and Expected Outcome: The study area will focus on Salugara and selective comparative references to nearby monasteries where relevant. Work will proceed in four stages: topic finalization and tool design; field data collection; analysis and chapter drafting; and final report writing with bibliography and annexures. The expected outcome is a grounded case study showing how sacred authenticity, interpretation quality, and community participation can together improve Buddhist cultural tourism without compromising monastic dignity. The report will provide practical suggestions for student research, local stakeholders, and destination planning discussions.

LETTER/CERTIFICATE OF APPROVAL (By the Supervisor)

I hereby certify that the proposal for the Project entitled _____ by _____ has been prepared after due consultation with me. The proposal has my approval and has, to my knowledge, the potential of developing into a comprehensive Project Work. I also agree to supervise the above mentioned Project till its completion.

Signature of the Supervisor: _____ Name: _____ Designation: _____
Address: _____

Checklist: Keep one copy with yourself. Submit one signed proposal copy to Programme Coordinator (BTS/BAVTM), SOTHSM, IGNOU.